

LEC # 02

PRINCIPLE OF MANAGEMENT

Management Roles by Henry Mintzberg

Henry Mintzberg has categorized the multifaceted roles of managers into three essential dimensions: **interpersonal**, **informational**, and **decisional** roles. These classifications serve as a valuable framework for comprehending the wide-ranging tasks and responsibilities inherent in managerial positions.

1. Interpersonal Roles– Managing Teams and Relationships

These roles revolve around a manager's interactions and relationships, both within and beyond the organization.

These roles focus on how a manager interacts with employees, stakeholders, and other departments. Within this category, managers undertake three primary roles:

- **Figurehead:**

Acts as a symbolic head of the team or department, attending meetings and events. Managers represent their organization through ceremonial duties and the quality of its values.

Example: A **Project Manager** represents the development team in client meetings.

- **Leader:** Motivates and guides the team to achieve development goals. making pivotal decisions, and providing support to their staff.

Example: A **CTO (Chief Technology Officer)** ensures that developers and engineers work efficiently on a new software update.

- **Liaison:** Managers establish relationships, fostering connections within and outside their organization to gather crucial information and access valuable resources.

Maintains connections between different teams and external stakeholders.

Example: A **Software Development Manager** collaborates with the marketing team to align product features with customer needs.

2. Informational Roles – Handling and Sharing Information

Managers act as a channel of information. These roles involve collecting, processing, and distributing information within and outside the organization. This category encompasses three primary informational roles:

◆ **Monitor:**

Managers observe their environment, staying aligned to internal and external developments that may impact their organization. Keeps track of industry trends, new technologies, and project progress.

Example: An **IT Manager** stays updated on the latest cybersecurity threats to protect company data.

◆ **Disseminator:**

Share important information with team members to ensure smooth workflow. Managers share important information with their teams and other stakeholders, ensuring that everyone possesses the essential knowledge required for their roles.

Example: A **Scrum Master** updates the development team on project deadlines and client feedback.

◆ **Spokesperson:**

Communicates key information to external parties such as clients, vendors, and investors. Managers represent their organization by communicating its goals, policies, and actions to external parties

Example: A **Tech Lead** presents the latest software updates to stakeholders or customers.

3 Decisional Roles – Making Critical Business and Technical Decisions

These roles focus on **decision-making and problem-solving**

In this domain, managers engage in the critical process of making choices and resolving issues within the organization.

Four primary decisional roles encompass this dimension:

◆ Entrepreneur:

Managers identify opportunities and innovative projects or improvements within their organization.

Example: A Startup Founder introduces a new AI-based feature to improve user experience.

◆ Disturbance Handler:

When conflicts or crises emerge, managers adeptly address them to maintain organizational stability and harmony. Solves unexpected problems in software development or operations.

Example: A **DevOps Manager** quickly fixes server downtime issues affecting an e-commerce website.

◆ **Resource Allocator:**

Managers allocate resources, including budgets, time, and personnel, strategically to various projects and initiatives, aligning them with organizational objectives. Distributes budget, manpower, and tools efficiently.

Example: A **CIO (Chief Information Officer)** decides which cloud services to invest in for better data storage.

◆ **Negotiator:**

Managers skillfully navigate negotiations, whether internally, with employees or departments, or externally, with other organizations or stakeholders, to secure agreements and resolve conflicts. Works on agreements with clients, vendors, and internal teams.

Example: A **Product Manager** negotiates feature priorities with stakeholders to meet deadlines.